GRADE 3

Curriculum Book

Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 3 - Curriculum Book

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

For: *the 3rd-grade classroom teacher running this curriculum for the first time.* ***Read time:*** *about 30 minutes.* ***Use:*** *read once before Week 1; revisit before each unit; return to the FAQ anytime.*

Where ideas come from

Skills, hobbies, needs - and the eyes to notice.

What this curriculum is — in two paragraphs

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

Cash to Company at Grade 3 takes the noticing muscles of K–2 and points them outward. The year theme is *business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs.* Students start with a Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web in Week 1, form trios with named roles in Week 4, learn to generate five ideas from one

problem in Unit 2, do whole-number cost/revenue/profit math on a hypothetical lemonade stand in Unit 3, and finish the year with a Capstone Day stand in Week 36. Cash is the host — a coin-shaped mascot who appears in eight short videos across the year, asking the year's spine question: *you picked this idea — how do you know somebody actually wants it?*

This is the first year of the 3-5 band. The math is friendly (whole numbers, no decimals). The writing is concrete (one-sentence promises, four-sentence defenses). The classroom default is the trio — three students, four roles, one shared idea. By June your students will be asking each other *what's your evidence?* in 8-year-old words. That's the win.

Pacing — the 36-week year at a glance

TRY THIS

Spot it in the wild

Walk through your house. Find three things somebody made or sold. Write the name of one. Who do you think bought it, and why?

WEEKS	UNIT	ANCHOR ARTIFACT	CASH VIDEOS
1–8	Unit 1 — Skills, hobbies, needs	Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web with two circled ideas	V1 (Week 1), V2 (Week 7)
9–18	Unit 2 — Five ideas from one problem	5-idea page + defense paragraph	V3 (Week 9), V4 (Week 17)
19–27	Unit 3 — Lemonade math + the logo	Cost/Revenue/Profit worksheet + logo + name	V5 (Week 19), V6 (Week 26)
28–36	Unit 4 — Run, tell the truth, fix	Run-of-day strip, honesty audit, first-try fix reflection, Capstone Day stand	V7 (Week 28), V8 (Week 35)

Default rhythm: **one 45-minute block per week,** plus a **15-minute follow-up** later in the week. Unit launches and Capstone Day extend to 60–75 minutes if your schedule permits. If you have less time, drop the follow-up — never drop the unit launch.

Classroom routines (run these all year)

WORDS TO KNOW

Skill
Something you have practiced enough to be good at.

Hobby
Something you do for fun, on your own time.

Need
A problem somebody has that they want solved.

Customer
The person who pays - not the person you wish would pay.

Idea
A skill, a hobby, or a need turned into a way to help someone.

The trio meeting (10 minutes, weekly)

Three students. Four roles. One agenda. Trios meet once a week for 10 minutes. The CEO runs the meeting. The agenda is always the same:

1. *What did our trio do last week?* (each member, 30 seconds)
2. *What's the one thing we need to do this week?*
3. *Anyone stuck? On what?*

Teach this in Week 4 the day you form trios. By Week 10, students should be running it without your prompt.

The Cash video routine (the launch and close)

Each unit gets a launch video and a close video. Total: 8 videos across the year, ~2:45 each.

Pre-watch protocol: *one prompt on the board.* Don't introduce the video; let Cash do that. Watch once. Pair-share the prompt for 2 minutes. Cold-call two students. Then move into the lesson.

After-watch protocol: tie the video back to the artifact students produced that day. Cash never tells students what to do; Cash names what they noticed.

The Vocabulary Spine

A single growing list in the back of the Capstone Journal. Add 4–6 words per unit. Frayer squares (definition · example · non-example · picture) are required for the four anchor terms only: **customer, problem, plan, profit.** All other terms get a one-word example or picture in the spine.

The Wall

Four spaces on a classroom wall, dedicated all year:

1. **The Charters Wall** — every trio's charter from Lesson 2.
2. **The Idea Wall** — sticky notes from class brainstorms (Lesson 4).
3. **The Numbers Wall** — anchor chart from Lesson 6 (cost/revenue/profit boxes).
4. **The Honesty Wall** — built in Lesson 9, lives the rest of the year.

Walls are not decoration. They're working surfaces. Add to them. Refer to them. By Week 36, families walking in for Capstone Day should be able to read the year off the walls.

The Capstone Journal

A single notebook (paper or digital) per student. All artifacts go in. Number the pages. The journal goes home on Capstone Day and not before.

How to teach the four anchor moves

> **MATH MOMENT**
>
> **Tally five**
>
> Ask five people: 'Would you buy this?' Tally yes and no with marks. Five marks each row. Did more say yes or no?

Move 1 — *Which people, and how do you know?*

The year's spine question. Ask it every time a student says "kids will love it." Don't accept "I just know." Push for one of three: I have the skill · I see the need · Kids would actually use it. By Week 12, students will ask each other.

Move 2 — *Five beats one.*

Idea generation is a skill. Quantity in Lesson 4, quality in Lesson 5. The most common stumble is the kid who freezes at idea 3. Coaching: "*Make idea 4 a worse version of idea 1. Make idea 5 the opposite of idea 1.*" Quantity unlocks quality.

Move 3 — *What's left.*

Profit is what's left after you pay the cost. Use the lemonade scenario every time a student gets stuck. "*You took in $16. You paid $4 back to whoever sold you the can. The $12 left in your pocket — that's profit.*" Coins on the table beat words on the board for the kid who isn't there yet.

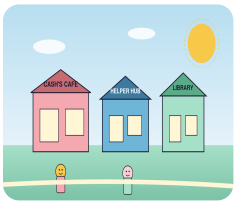
Move 4 — *Honest sells longer.*

The Honest or Misleading sort in Lesson 9 is the year's ethics anchor. Don't moralize. Use the three tip-offs: *everyone · no number · sounds-fancy-but-vague.* If a student's family uses a product the class flags as misleading, protect the student — the lesson is about the claim, not the household.

FAQ

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real customers

Family, neighbors, classmates, teachers, the person at the corner store. Five real people beats one good guess.

My class can't form trios — I have 28 students.

28 ÷ 3 = 9 trios with one extra student. Make one quad (4 students with the four roles fully split). Or run 9 trios + a "Cash's Cabinet" — the extra student is a class-wide helper who rotates through trios as needed. Both work.

What if a student refuses to name a skill?

Don't accept "*I have nothing.*" Use the backup list: caring for a pet, remembering names, listening when a sibling is upset, making people laugh, drawing from memory, knowing routines. Those count. If still stuck, conference 1:1 in Week 2 with three prompts: "*What do you do every day at home?*" "*What does your grown-up brag about you?*" "*What does your teacher last year say you were good at?*" Something will land.

A student wants to do a Capstone idea I don't think will work.

Two questions to ask: "*Whose skill is this idea using?*" and "*How would you ask three kids if they want it?*" If the answer to either is shaky, redirect: "*Pick from the teacher list for now. You can revise in Week 19.*" Don't kill ideas in Week 4 — set up the pivot window.

Math is uneven — some kids can't yet do 16 × $1.

Lesson 6 is the math anchor. Three coaching moves: (1) Use coins on the table for the first scenario. Concrete first. (2) Reduce to 3 scenarios for IEP/504 students; the standards (3.OA.D.8) are met at 3 scenarios. (3) Pair students for the worksheet — money keeper does the math, sales says it aloud. Multiplication of one-digit by two-digit numbers is on grade for end-of-Grade-3, so this lesson belongs in spring (Week 19) for a reason.

A family says they don't want their child running a "stand."

Two paths: (1) The Capstone Day stand is a *paper version* by default. The actual stand is optional. (2) If the family is uncomfortable with the marketing/pitching aspect, the student can be a *Capstone Reporter* — they walk other trios' stands and write a 1-paragraph "what I noticed" report instead of running their own. They still hit all eight strand outcomes.

A trio falls apart at the last minute.

Common in Week 30–34. Three rescues: (1) Pair the broken trio with a finished trio for the 90-second pitch — their stand stands on its own; the pitch is collaborative across trios. (2) Reassign roles for Capstone Day only. Sometimes the CEO needs to be the designer. (3) If one student is genuinely solo, give them a 1-person stand and reduce the artifact list to logo + name + profit + first-try fix. Three artifacts is enough for assessment.

How do I grade this without crushing the joy?

Use the Rubric Bank. At Grade 3, scaling drops to: **Business Plan Rubric** (4 criteria, no operations or self-assessment criterion), **Reflection Writing Rubric** (full 4 criteria with simplified language). Holistic scoring is allowed for Cash-video reflections. The Capstone gets analytic scoring across the four checkpoints. Letter grades are not required at this level if your district allows narrative reporting; narrative beats letters at this age.

What do I do with the kid who's miles ahead?

Push for evidence even at this grade. Three moves: (1) Add a second pricing scenario — "*what if you only sold 8 cups?*" (Lesson 6). (2) Add a "*one way I could be wrong*" sentence to every defense (Lesson 5). (3) Make them a Vocabulary Spine helper — they teach 1 word per week to the class with their own example. Peer-teaching cements the term and stretches the student.

How do I avoid sounding like I'm pushing wealth?

Cash never says "amazing!", "boss up," "easy money," "everyone can be rich," or "if you can dream it you can do it." Cash celebrates the move, not the win. "*You didn't make money this year. That's the win — you did the work.*" The Cash Style Guide is the law. Re-read it before Capstone Day.

Common pitfalls (and the fix)

FAMILY TALK

Skill, hobby, or need?

At dinner, name one skill, one hobby, and one need somebody at the table has. Could any of them turn into a tiny business?

PITFALL	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	FIX
The everyone-customer	"My business is for everyone."	"*Everyone is a way to say nobody. Who's the first one?*"
The mystery profit	Student writes "I made $$$" with no math.	Send back to the worksheet. "*Show your cost, show your revenue, show what's left.*"
The pretty-but-empty logo	A heart or a smiley.	"*Hearts say love. Does your business sell love?*" Push for a shape that says something true.
The skip-the-step plan	Run-of-day strip with no Clean step.	Read the Sticky Pitcher story (Lesson 8). "*What breaks if you skip it?*"
The clever-but-misleading tagline	"Best lemonade in school!"	Run the three tip-offs from Lesson 9. "*What's the proof? If there's no number, fix it or drop it.*"
The trio's loudest voice	One student picks the idea, others nod.	"*Whose skill is this using? Whose hobby?*" Force three voices into the charter.
The "I have nothing" kid	Student says they have no skills.	Backup list above. Don't accept "*nothing.*"
The brand-name tangent	Class debates whether [name brand] is misleading.	Steer to the cards. "*We're judging the claim, not the company. Use the cards.*"

Calibration — how to score the Capstone

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

The Capstone is scored across four checkpoints (Weeks 8, 18, 27, 36) using the elementary-band scaling.

Checkpoint 1 (Week 8) — Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web + Trio Charter. Score: *Customer clarity* (Business Plan Rubric, criterion 1, scaled). 4 points possible.

Checkpoint 2 (Week 18) — 5-idea page + defense paragraph. Score: *Reasoning quality* (Reflection Writing Rubric, scaled). 4 points possible.

Checkpoint 3 (Week 27) — Cost/Revenue/Profit worksheet + Logo + Name. Score: *Mathematical accuracy* (Budget Project Rubric, scaled, 4 criteria) + *Communication* (Business Plan Rubric, criterion 6, scaled). 8 points possible.

Checkpoint 4 (Week 36) — Run-of-day strip, honesty audit, first-try fix reflection, 90-second pitch. Score: *Operations* + *Honest claims* + *Reflection* (composite — pull descriptors from Rubrics 1, 2, and 5). 12 points possible.

Total possible: 28 points. Most students land in the 18–24 range. Below 14 triggers a 1:1 conference and a make-up artifact, not a failure. The point is the move, not the score.

Anchor papers. Pull a 3 (Proficient) anchor early in the year — typically the second 5-idea page you read at high quality. Use it to recalibrate before scoring.

Working with families

The Parent Guide goes home in Week 1 with the syllabus. It includes one good question per quarter. The Family Visit invitation goes home in Week 33 (3 weeks before Capstone Day). For families who can't visit:

- Record the trio's pitch on a phone.
- Share via the class platform.

- Offer a make-up Family Visit window (15-minute walk-in slots in Week 37).

Sensitivity: never ask a student to bring in receipts, ingredient costs from home, or family pricing. "*For a hypothetical lemonade stand, the can costs $4.*" That number comes from the worksheet, not from home.

Sensitivity flags — re-read each unit

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

1. **Family money.** Never ask about household budget. Use "*for a hypothetical*" / "*for a sample.*"
2. **Skills as worth.** Don't let a student say "*I have nothing.*" Push past the shrug. Sensitivity-flagged.
3. **Need-naming.** No kid's name on the Needs circle. Critique situations, not classmates.
4. **The lemonade stand and food safety.** Paper version is the default. If running a real stand, school-cleared sealed ingredients only, hand-washing routine non-negotiable.
5. **Brand-name claims.** In Lesson 9, use the program cards, not real brands. If a student brings in a real product label, anonymize the brand in the discussion.
6. **The first-try flop.** Lesson 10's reflection asks what went wrong. This is celebration, not shame. Cash voice: "*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

Cross-grade hooks (named explicitly)

- **From Grade 2:** the *Problem → Idea* card and the *fair to the customer* check directly seed the Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web (Lesson 1) and the Honest or Misleading sort (Lesson 9).
- **To Grade 4:** the *5-question Reality Check* (Who buys? How much? How many? What does it cost me? What's left?) is exactly what Lessons 4, 5, and 6 set up. Strong Grade 3 work feeds the Grade 4 1-page plan template.

If your school runs vertical articulation, share the Capstone Journals with the receiving Grade 4 teacher. A 5-minute hand-off conversation in June saves three weeks of re-establishing norms in September.

Final word

You don't need to have run a business to teach this year. You need to be willing to model two moves: noticing your own skill out loud ("*I am good at remembering everyone's name. That is a skill.*"), and asking *which people, and how do you know?* every time a student says "kids will love it." The Cash videos take pressure off introducing concepts. The lesson plans take pressure off pacing. By Week 12, your students will be asking each other *what's your evidence?* in 8-year-old words. That is the win — and that is the year.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Differentiation deep moves (Grade 3)

Advanced learners — three named extensions

1. **Multi-volume profit thinking.** When a student computes profit at one volume, ask for the other two volumes (10, 25, 50 cups). They learn the linearity of profit-with-variable-cost intuitively.

2. **Logo-as-message critique.** Take a real local business logo and ask the student: "*What does this say to a customer before they go in?*" This builds CBM brand-thinking that anchors Grade 7 work.
3. **The skills-I-could-build column.** Add a fourth column to the Skills + Hobbies + Needs web. Pushes self-direction.

ELL deep moves

- **Visual cost/revenue/profit chart.** Three boxes always in the same order on a poster. Translate the box labels to the student's home language for the first month.
- **Cognates.** Spanish *costo, ingreso, ganancia*. Use the home-language word once, English three times.
- **Pair on the math, independent on the writing.** Math is universal; the write-up is harder.

IEP/504 deep moves

- **Calculator allowed for all profit math.** The reasoning is the goal, not the arithmetic.
- **Pre-printed cost-revenue-profit grid for every scenario.** Three columns, labeled.
- **Trio role rotation.** Some IEP students do best in one role for a longer stretch. Allow a 4-week stay before rotating.

Sensitivity tightening for Grade 3

Replace any prompt that asks "how much does your family spend on..." with "for a hypothetical family at the grocery store..." Verify your worksheet sets follow this rule.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cash Never Says (Teacher Reference Card)

Cash never says: "Amazing!" / "Awesome!" / "Crushing it!" / "Boss up" / "Get that bag" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Anyone can be a millionaire" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Financial freedom" / "Just believe" / "Believe in yourself" (as substitute for evidence) / "If you can dream it, you can do it" / "Side hustle" (use "side venture") / wealth-flexing language / anything implying wealth is mindset/hustle / anything implying low-income/ unbanked families are at fault.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?" / "What would have to be true for you to be right?" / "Whats one thing youd change?"

Teacher mirror: Replace "great job!" with "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?"

Cashs three signature physical moves: (1) **Notebook Tilt** — turning the clipboard toward camera before reading a quote; (2) **Two-Finger Tap** — tapping a number twice when emphasizing it; (3) **Slow Lean** — leaning toward camera before a contrarian truth.

FROM CASH

What I do, what I love, what I notice

Three questions. Three sentences. Three ideas. That's how a business starts - not with a logo, with a list.

KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 3 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Spending and saving - earning money, choices, opportunity cost.

CEE NS3
Productive resources, scarcity, and choice.

CCSS-MATH 3.MD
Measurement and data - survey customers, tally results.

CCSS-ELA SL.3.1
Engage in collaborative discussions - pitch and feedback.

CASEL Self-Awareness
Identify strengths, interests, and values.

C3 D2.Eco.1.3-5
Compare benefits and costs of choices.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it? — Cash

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